

have quietly built a profile so that they can display ads of products that interest you, but very often against your will.

In this article, we're going to check out six private search engines that safeguard the user's privacy and do not collect their data. All of them also offer various useful features and privacy settings.

DuckDuckGo

DuckDuckGo is one of the most popular private search engines. It protects its users by not collecting IP addresses and the user agent's information. DuckDuckGo doesn't store any tracking cookies on your system — the cookies are only saved in your system if you select the feature on the site that requires it to remember something. But even this cannot be used to identify you personally.

Instead of jumping between the pages of search results, DuckDuckGo dumps search results on a single page so that you can scroll through that page itself until you reach your desired search result.

When displaying results, DuckDuckGo sets *Safe* search as *Strict* so that the search results get filtered and show the results that are free from potentially explicit content.

DuckDuckGo has a cool feature called Bangs. These are much like shortcuts to websites that you can directly access without having to search for them or type their complete URL. Currently, DuckDuckGo supports 11,414 Bangs on various topics.

Startpage

When you are trying out a new search engine, you will naturally be comparing the search results with those of earlier search engines.

Startpage provides Google-quality search results but with full privacy protection. Typically, Startpage acts as an intermediary. Whenever you use Startpage, the search results are fetched from Google, but instead of information about you getting transmitted to Google, Startpage makes the request on

your behalf and returns the same search results to you without compromising your privacy.

Startpage also offers 'anonymous view' for the websites in its search results. This is because even though you are using a private search engine, once you click on a website, you could be tracked by the trackers on that website. However, when using 'anonymous view', the website cannot see your IP address or any identifiers. Instead, to them, it will look like Startpage's IP address is accessing that website. However, there's a catch when using 'anonymous view' — not all the elements on the website will be displayed properly.

Qwant

Qwant is a privacy-respecting search engine from France. It protects its users by using anonymous search queries. It also doesn't store the searches you made on it. Qwant makes sure that you are not tracked based on your searches.

The Qwant search interface offers a panoramic view of the search results, enabling users to get various types of search results classified as 'Web', 'Images', 'Videos', 'Social', 'News' and 'Shopping' on a single page. Users may swap between the different kinds of search results. The results provided in Qwant are unbiased, so all information is treated equally. The search results are not manipulated and neither is the order in which they are displayed.

Qwant also offers a music search engine known as Qwant Music. If you enter an artist's name, it will display an overview of him, his discography, news articles on the musician, music videos and information on any upcoming concerts, and much more.

Qwant Board is an additional service apart from its Web search. By using these boards you can save your own content (videos, images, etc). You can share your boards with other users, they can view them and follow your boards, and even comment on them. But you must have a Qwant account to

avail this service.

Qwant Junior is an extension of Qwant Search, which is designed especially for kids between the ages of 6-13. Qwant makes sure that the search results displayed are free of ads as well, apart from filtering out violence and explicit content.

Searx

Searx is a free meta-search engine that combines search results from other search engines on a single page. The engine uses approximately 70 sites as its search sources, so the results are not from one site but from many. Thus, it prevents personalisation of search results.

Searx classifies the search results in the following categories — General, Files, Images, It, Map, Music, News, Science, Social Media and Videos. This is so that you may select the appropriate category according to your needs. Under the Files category, Searx shows direct links to the Torrent files based on the search terms you entered.

Ads are stripped from the search results before they are displayed to the users. Also, you can use Searx along with Tor for online anonymity. Searx doesn't track users nor does it profile users based on their searches.

Searx doesn't use cookies by default and the requests made by Searx are 'POST' requests for transmitting your queries to other search engines so that those queries cannot be intercepted and read by others.

Unlike other search engines, Searx is self-hostable free software. If you're uncomfortable about trusting an outside party with your data, you can run your own instance so that you may have absolute control over your data.

Unbubble

Unbubble is a European neutral meta search engine from Germany. As its name implies, Unbubble represents a solution for the search bubble problem — sometimes a search engine may deliberately decide what information should be seen by the user based on